

ERA Minicon - ALIFE 2026, Waterloo

Sunday 16 August 2026 | Waterloo, Canada + livestream | Hybrid event | 09:00-17:15 EDT

Free for everyone in the ERA server - no registration or ALIFE conference ticket needed. The AMMCS-ALIFE Welcoming Reception follows at 7:00 PM EDT.

Programme

Time (EDT)	Time (JST)	Time (CEST)	Session	Speaker	Mode	Notes
09:00-09:30	22:00-22:30	15:00-15:30	Welcome, ERA intro & icebreaker	ERA organisers	In person	
09:30-10:15	22:30-23:15	15:30-16:15	Don't get trapped by your research question! Tips to harness the scientific potential of your curiosity	Lana Sinapayen	Remote	30 min talk + 15 min Q&A.
10:15-10:45	23:15-23:45	16:15-16:45	Coffee break & snack exchange			Bring a snack from your home country and share it with the others!
10:45-11:45	23:45-00:45 (+1)	16:45-17:45	The career landscape for ALifers: academia, industry and in between	Alyssa Adams	Remote	60 min incl. Q&A.
11:45-12:30	00:45-01:30 (+1)	17:45-18:30	The Artificial Life Institute and my own path into the field	Bert Chan	In person	30 min talk + 15 min Q&A.
12:30-13:30	01:30-02:30 (+1)	18:30-19:30	Lunch break			
13:30-14:30	02:30-03:30 (+1)	19:30-20:30	Criticality of a path through idea space and academia: the Levin Lab's work through the last 25 years	Michael Levin	Remote	60 min incl. Q&A.
14:30-15:00	03:30-04:00 (+1)	20:30-21:00	Coffee break			
15:00-16:00	04:00-05:00 (+1)	21:00-22:00	How to write a good paper	Susan Stepney	In person	60 min incl. Q&A.
16:00-17:00	05:00-06:00 (+1)	22:00-23:00	A bit on "Life in Z80", how it came about, and how I ended up here.	Eyvind Niklasson	In person	45 min + 15 min Q&A.
17:00-17:15	06:00-06:15 (+1)	23:00-23:15	Wrap-up, announcements & pointer to the ERA Workshop (18 Aug)	ERA organisers	In person	

Q&A: Post questions in each speaker announcement thread in the ERA Discord server. **Related:** ERA Workshop - Artificial Life in the Wild - 18 August 2026.

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